

Player Quickstart: Speaking Dabar

One Phrase. One roll. One personal cost. One persistent consequence.

1. How to Cast a Phrase

Choose & Frame: Select an approved Phrase card. State your intent in one sentence.

Pay Fixed Strain: Mark the printed Strain cost on your character sheet before rolling (Minor = 1, Major = 2, Consequential = 3).

Roll: Roll d20 + casting modifier against the Phrase's printed DC (10, 15, or 20).

Frayed Location: The GM may add **+2** to the DC. Do not stack World Drift or environmental modifiers on ordinary casts.

Resolve:

Success (DC or higher): The Phrase effect takes place.

Failure (below DC): Apply the card's printed **Failure Echo**.

Natural 1: Apply the Failure Echo **plus** a minor narrative complication.

Natural 20: Best valid effect with no narrative drawback.

2. Tracking Strain (0–6)

Strain measures temporary harmonic pressure. Mark boxes as you cast:

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0–2 (Clear): Standard operation.

3–4 (Pressured): Gain a visible Fray tell or minor narrative complication.

5 (Unstable): The next failed or risky Phrase imposes a **Personal Condition**.

6 (Overflow): Safe casting is locked. You must recover or use **Force It**.

Recovery

Short Rest (10 mins): Clear 2 Strain.

Long Rest (8 hours): Clear all Strain.

3. Force It (At 6 Strain)

When maxed on Strain, you may declare **Force It** before rolling a Phrase:

Effect: Succeeds automatically if stated on the card; otherwise, roll normally.

Consequence: You gain one **Personal Condition** regardless of success or failure.

Local Impact: If the cast alters the environment, the GM assigns a **Local Condition**.

Lockout: You cannot cast another Phrase until Strain is reduced below 6.

4. Conditions vs. Strain

Strain: Temporary, recoverable resource pressure.

Personal Conditions: Lasting, persistent character traits caused by severe pressure (e.g., VOICE CARRIES A SECOND HARMONIC, HAND PHASES UNDER STRESS). Requires narrative resolution, milestone progression, or divine intervention to clear.

Local Conditions: Lasting spatial changes recorded by the GM (e.g., LATTICE NODE SCARRED).

Table Rules Summary

No Backlash Table: Resolved entirely via card **Failure Echoes**.

No Manual Arithmetic: Use printed card values; do not calculate glyph-level costs at the table.

No Unregistered Phrases: Use only approved Phrase cards or site-bound module rites.